NO SURPRISES HERE

In cricket, IPL hero M.S. Dhoni regains top spot, Smriti Mandhana leads among women. Neeraj Chopra and P.V. Sindhu head lists in other sports

By **SUHANI SINGH**

India Today's Mood of the Nation poll offers ample proof of how heavily Indians are invested in the Indian Premier League. It's why Mahendra Singh Dhoni, who won the IPL for the fifth time with Chennai Super Kings, beat members of the national squad to emerge as India's number one cricketer. Dhoni, who is hugely popular even after three years of retirement, is succeeded by another former captain, albeit one who is a vital part of the team—Virat Kohli. With the ICC Cricket World Cup on home turf, the pressure is on the likes of Kohli, Rohit Sharma (No. 3) and Hardik Pandya (No. 5) to deliver on the country's expectations.

Among female cricketers, Women's Premier League's most expensive player, Smriti Mandhana, topped rankings. The champion batsperson failed to perform for Royal Challengers Bengaluru, but has a large fan base. Indian captain Harmanpreet Kaur, who led Mumbai Indians to the title, is next. Among non-cricket sportspersons, it's hard to topple Olympic champion Neeraj Chopra from the top perch. Captains of India's football and hockey teams, Sunil Chhetri and Harmanpreet Singh, came second and

Q. Who is India's No. 1 male cricketer?

1 M.S. DHONI **40%**



2 VIRAT KOHLI **35%**



4 SURYAKUMAR YADAV **4%**



3 ROHIT SHARMA **6%**



5 HARDIK PANDYA **3%**



GETTY IMAGES